



AFRICAN CONNECTIONS
"Your Gateway to Africa"

Welcomes You to **SENEGAL**



Thank you for choosing African Connections to provide comprehensive tour services for your upcoming “Senegal, African Culture & Safari Tour” scheduled for September 20th - 28th 2026 (8 nights/9 days).

African Connections, “AC” is your Gateway to Africa. We have been a leader in African travel for over 20 years and the entire AC Team is preparing for your upcoming visit to Senegal.

We pride ourselves on delivery of outstanding concierge services and we are happy to assist you and provide you with information you’ll need to prepare for your journey.

When you reach Senegal, we will meet you at the airport when you arrive and assist you throughout your stay in Senegal.

Our team is knowledgeable and professional and proud to show you the wonders of Senegal, a country we know so well.

This welcome guide will provide you with information that will be helpful as you make your travel preparations.

Please review this information carefully. We welcome your questions and look forward to seeing you in Senegal soon!

Your Tour

You should book your tickets so that you depart from the USA on September 19th 2026, with your arrival in Senegal on September 20th 2026.

Your tickets should have you depart from Senegal on September 28th 2026, and arrive back in the United States on September 29th 2026.

Your tour begins when you arrive in Senegal on September 20th and ends when we see you off at the airport on September 28th 2026.

Senegal Travel Requirements

Senegal is a tourist friendly destination, but it is important that you are aware of travel requirements and have your travel documents ready well in advance of your departure date. Please read the following information carefully.

Passports and Visas

A valid passport is required for all international travel.

U.S. citizens do not need a visa to enter Senegal for stays of up to 90 days. However, there are other requirements to meet, including:

Passport: A valid U.S. passport with at least one blank visa page

Proof of travel: Proof of return or onward flights

Proof of funds: Proof of sufficient funds for the duration of your stay

Proof of purpose: Documents showing the purpose of your trip

Your passport must be valid for at least six months from the date of your arrival back in the United States. Check your passport expiration date to be sure it meets this requirement and if necessary, apply for a renewal as soon as possible. You will not be allowed to board your departure flight if your passport expiration date is within six months of your scheduled return to your home country.

Immunization and Medical Information

Yellow Fever Vaccination:

A current yellow fever vaccination is required if you are arriving from an infected area within 5 days. However, it is not required by US Citizens if you have not been in an infected area.

If you get the Yellow Fever vaccine, be sure this is indicated in your yellow International Certificate of Vaccination or Prophylaxis (ICVP). **It is your responsibility to comply with all immunization requirements.**

Malaria Prevention and other Immunizations:

Your doctor might also recommend other vaccinations which are not mandatory for travel to Senegal. It is up to you to decide if you take any or all such recommended vaccinations as they are not required for entry into Senegal.

While it is not mandatory, we strongly recommend that you acquire anti-malarial medication. Malaria is a serious potential (but treatable) health threat, and you should take necessary precautions to minimize your risk.

It is also a good idea to bring your favorite mosquito repellant to further protect yourself from the mosquitos that you might encounter.

Prescription Medications:

If you take prescription medication, you are responsible for determining their legality in Senegal and note the following:

- We advise you to bring enough of your medication with you.
- Always keep your medication in the original container.
- Carry a copy of your prescription(s).
- Pack your medicine in your carry-on luggage, not your checked luggage.

Travel Insurance

Travel Insurance is not included in your package. However, it is strongly recommended that you purchase travel insurance to cover any unexpected event that might interrupt or prevent your travel.

Our company offers optional travel insurance through Allianz Global, a leader in the travel insurance field. You can click on the link below or go to our website www.africanconnections-usa.com to get a quote.

https://www.agentmaxonline.com/agentmaxweb/widgets/quotetool.html?widgetid=859099&ac_cam=F212819&code=ABIYU4TLWGBGTNHC6ZWLRSKAR65GB6C5JLBJOIXR7QY3M6I5HDDHZDIECAM4JHS6KBOBIU5FYWBJM3BAHKTFTOR572B73AM4ZH74ZMNXXVK3YLBWT3Z3F4X4R3Z53LEU4

Shopping in Senegal

You will love shopping in Senegal! Whether you're bargaining for unique handicrafts at a bustling local market or exploring the stylish boutiques in Dakar, Senegal offers a vibrant shopping experience for everyone. From colorful textiles and handmade jewelry to high-end fashion and artisanal goods, you're sure to find the perfect treasures to take home!

Clothing and Packing

Bring comfortable outfits. Cotton or other fabrics that breathe will help you stay comfortable. It will be warm in Senegal. We advise that you bring a light sweater or jacket for evenings and/or early mornings and wear comfortable shoes or sandals.

Note: Senegal is a conservative, predominantly Muslim country, so dress modestly and avoid revealing clothing. There will be opportunities to swim, so pack your swimsuit and add a swim cover too.

Don't bring electrical appliances and gadgets. The electric outlets in Senegal are 220 volts, while U.S. appliances are 110 volts. **This means you will not be able to use your U.S. small**

appliances and devices in Senegal. The exceptions are laptops, phone chargers and other such devices which are usually universal and should work in Senegal. You might need an adapter for these devices, however, as the outlets in Senegal are a different shape than those common in the U.S.

You can bring your own adapter or buy one when you arrive as adapters are very inexpensive in Senegal and are readily available.

Toiletries/Personal Items

Be sure you bring all your toiletries and personal items. While you will have opportunities to buy such things in Senegal, you might not be able to find the brands you prefer.

Customs Requirements

Passengers' obligations at Senegal Customs are outlined on the **Senegal Revenue Authority** website, see **www.impots.gouv.sn** for details.

When you arrive in Senegal you will pass through Senegal Customs, and you might be asked if you have anything to declare. You must declare any commercial goods or currency more than \$10,000 that you bring into Senegal.

Money/Credit and Debit Cards/ATM's:

Cash

There is no limit on the amount of money you can bring into Senegal. However, as stated above, if you bring in more than \$10,000 in cash, you must declare it when you pass through customs on entry. If you bring in less than \$10,000, there is no need to declare any cash that you bring in. You will have several opportunities to change your dollars for the local currency during your stay in Senegal. Please note that it is advisable that you bring any cash that you bring in either \$100 or \$50 bills as smaller denominations will be exchanged for a significantly lower exchange rate.

ATMs

There are ATMs in all the major cities you visit, but you will pay an international fee and a local bank fee for ATM transactions in addition to possibly receiving a lower exchange rate for each transaction.

Credit and Debit Cards

There will be a few places where you can use your credit or debit card, but for the most part, Senegal is a cash economy. If you intend to use your debit or credit card, when this option is

available, you should inform your bank that you are traveling to Senegal to prevent a fraud alert or possible block of your card when you try to use it in Senegal.

Also, note, many of the businesses that take debit or credit cards use POS equipment which requires a pin number. While we all know our debit card pin number, most of us do not have or know a pin number for our credit cards. So, if you intend to use a credit card, contact your bank, and make sure you have and know the pin number associated with the card.

Note: the only credit cards accepted in Senegal are Visa and Mastercard.

Food and Water

Your tour package includes breakfast daily and other specified meals (lunch/dinner), including a Welcome Dinner with Cultural Performances.

You will be able to buy meals that are not included in the tour package at restaurants that we have carefully selected. There will be many food choices and you will be able to sample delicious Senegalese dishes, but more familiar dishes will also be available to you. The average cost of a meal with a soft drink and water, in Senegal ranges from \$15-\$25.

Bottled water is readily available. However, the water in all of the hotels and restaurants that have been selected for you is potable and is safe for you to drink, use as ice cubes or to brush your teeth.

While some of your favorite snacks might be available in Senegal, and we will make regular stops for you to stock up on snacks, fruit, and drinks during the trip, it is advisable for you to bring the special snacks that you prefer.

Hotels and Restaurants in Senegal:

Hotels

You will be staying at hotels that have been carefully selected for you to ensure your comfort. These hotels are highly rated with clean comfortable rooms and well-trained staff. However, standards might vary from those to which you might be accustomed.

For example, while bath towels and hand towels are available and supplied at all the selected hotels, face cloths are not normally available. So, you should bring your own face cloth.

Rest assured; our ground staff will be available to address any issue that might arise.

Restaurants

We have carefully selected each of the restaurants you will visit on your tour. These restaurants will provide clean, wholesome food giving you the choice of local Senegalese dishes or continental dishes that are more familiar.

While the food is tasty, Senegalese restaurants are known for slow service, so you might have to exercise a bit of patience before your meal arrives. Whenever possible, our staff will help you to place your order in advance of arrival at a restaurant, to cut down on the wait time.

Cell Phone/Data Usage and Internet Service:

Before your departure to Senegal contact your mobile phone service provider and request international data service to access WhatsApp, or similar apps for internet-based communications. Such communications are significantly less costly than international roaming charges.

You could also ask for a one-month international voice package. While this could be costly, it is cheaper than the bill you will receive if you make calls without a call package.

If you make or receive international calls while you are in Senegal and you do not have the appropriate international call/data packages, you will be shocked when you receive your telephone service billing statement.

Other information that might be helpful as you prepare for your trip:

Country Profile

Senegal is bordered by the Atlantic Ocean to the west, with neighboring countries including Mauritania to the north and east, Mali to the east, and Guinea and Guinea-Bissau to the south. The Gambia, a narrow strip of land, cuts through the southern part of Senegal, creating a unique geographical feature. The country has a tropical climate with distinct dry and wet seasons.

The capital of Senegal is Dakar, located on the Cape Verde Peninsula along the Atlantic coast. Other major cities include Saint-Louis, Kaolack, and Tambacounda. Senegal has a population of approximately 18 million people, with a diverse mix of ethnic groups, including Wolof, Pulaar, Serer, and Jola. The country is predominantly Muslim, with a small Christian minority.

Senegal was historically home to powerful empires and kingdoms before being colonized by the French in the 17th century. It gained independence in 1960, with Léopold Sédar Senghor as its first president. Senegal has maintained political stability and democratic governance since independence.

Geography:

Senegal, officially the Republic of Senegal, is the westernmost country in West Africa, situated on the Atlantic Ocean coastline. It borders Mauritania to the north, Mali to the east, Guinea to the southeast, and Guinea-Bissau to the southwest. Senegal nearly surrounds The Gambia, a country occupying a narrow sliver of land along the banks of the Gambia River, which separates Senegal's southern region of Casamance from the rest of the country. It also shares a maritime border with Cape Verde.

Senegal covers a land area of almost 197,000 square kilometres (76,000 sq mi) and has a population of around 18 million. The state is a unitary presidential republic; since the country's foundation in 1960, it has been recognized as one of the most stable countries on the African continent.

Economy:

The economy of Senegal is primarily based on agriculture (especially peanuts, millet, and cotton), fishing, and mining. It has also developed growing sectors in services, tourism, and infrastructure. The country does not have notable natural resources, but the basis of its development lies in education.

The Currency

The West African CFA franc (XOF) is the currency of Senegal. The currency code for the CFA franc is XOF, and it is commonly represented by the symbol CFA. The exchange rate between the CFA franc and the U.S. dollar fluctuates, so you will be able to exchange dollars for CFA francs upon arrival at the prevailing rate. There is no limit on the amount of cash you can bring into Senegal, but any amount exceeding \$5,000 must be declared upon entry. Lesser amounts do not require a declaration.

Language:

The official language of Senegal is French. The state was formed as part of the independence of French West Africa from French colonial rule. Because of this history, French is the official language, but it is understood by only a minority of the population. Over 30 languages are spoken in Senegal. Wolof is the most widely spoken one, with 80% of the population speaking it as a first or second language. Therefore, you should not have any difficulty communicating with locals and fully enjoying every aspect of your stay in Senegal.

Government:

Senegal is a republic with a presidency; the president is elected every five years as of 2016, previously being seven years from independence to 2001, five years from 2001 to 2008, and seven years again from 2008 to 2016, by adult voters. The constitution of Senegal was adopted on March 3, 1963 and later amended in 1992 consisting of three branches: The Executive., Legislative, and

the Judiciary. The President is the head of state, while the Prime Minister is the head of government. Senegal's government is based on a combination of executive, legislative, and judicial branches, and elections are held for the President and Parliament. Senegal has elections once every five years.

Current President: Bassirou Diomaye Faye
Prime minister: Ousmane Sonko

History:

Before European colonization, Senegal was home to several powerful kingdoms and empires, such as the Kingdom of Wolof, the Mali Empire, and the Kingdom of Cayor. These societies had rich cultures, complex political systems, and thriving trade networks, especially along the Senegal River. In the 15th century, Portuguese explorers first reached Senegal, followed by the French in the 17th century. Senegal became a key part of French colonial interests, with Saint-Louis (now a UNESCO World Heritage site) and Dakar as important ports for the transatlantic slave trade. In the 19th century, the French established control over the entire region.

In the 20th century, Senegal saw a rise in nationalist movements. Leaders like Blaise Diagne and Léopold Sédar Senghor pushed for greater political rights and independence. Senegal was part of French West Africa, but after World War II, the desire for self-rule grew stronger. On April 4, 1960, Senegal gained independence from France, with Léopold Sédar Senghor becoming the first president. Senghor is known for promoting a policy of "African socialism" and emphasizing the importance of African cultural identity.

Climate:

Senegal has a tropical climate with distinct wet and dry seasons. The coastal regions, including Dakar, experience warm temperatures with ocean breezes that help moderate the heat, while the interior tends to be hotter and drier. Temperature variations throughout the year are relatively small, with an average daily temperature of around 30°C (86°F).

The coolest time of the year is between December and February, during the Harmattan season, when dry winds from the Sahara bring cooler mornings and evenings. The minimum temperature can drop to around 18°C (64°F) in some areas, while daytime highs remain comfortable. The main rainy season occurs from June to October, with the heaviest rainfall in August and September, bringing lush green landscapes across the country.

Senegal enters its dry season in November, with little to no rainfall and warm temperatures. In coastal cities like Dakar, daytime temperatures average 86°F (30°C), with nighttime lows around 73°F (23°C). Rainfall is minimal, and sunshine hours are abundant. In interior regions such as Tambacounda, temperatures range from 77°F to 95°F (25°C to 35°C) as the rainy season comes to an end. September in Senegal falls within the wet season (June–October), meaning you can expect high humidity, warm temperatures, and occasional rainfall. With respect to temperature, daytime highs range from 80–90°F (27–32°C), while nights are cooler at around 75°F (24°C).

September is an excellent time for travel, with favorable weather for outdoor activities and exploring Senegal's diverse landscapes.

Frequently Asked Questions

General Travel Information

1. Do I need a visa to visit Senegal?

U.S. citizens can visit Senegal for up to 90 days without a visa. Your passport must be valid for at least six months beyond your departure date and have at least one blank page for entry stamps.

2. What vaccinations do I need before traveling?

A Yellow Fever vaccination is required for entry into Senegal. Other recommended vaccines include Hepatitis A & B, typhoid, tetanus, and malaria prophylaxis.

3. Is Senegal safe for tourists?

Senegal is one of the safest countries in West Africa. However, tourists should remain cautious in crowded areas, avoid carrying large sums of cash, and use registered taxis or ride-hailing services.

4. What is the best time to visit Senegal?

The best time to visit Senegal is from November to May and September. September in Senegal falls within the wet season (June–October), meaning you can expect high humidity, warm temperatures, and occasional rainfall. With respect to temperature, daytime highs range from 80–90°F (27–32°C), while nights are cooler at around 75°F (24°C).

5. What is the dress code in Senegal?

Light, breathable clothing is ideal due to the warm climate. Modest attire is

recommended when visiting religious or traditional sites. Senegal is a conservative, predominantly Muslim country, so dress modestly and avoid revealing clothing. Also, there will be opportunities to swim, so pack your swimsuit and add a swim cover too.

6. Are public toilets available at tourist sites?

Public toilets are available at major tourist attractions, but they may not always be well-maintained. Carry tissues and hand sanitizer.

7. Is there internet access?

Hotels, cafes, and restaurants in major cities offer Wi-Fi. A local SIM card is recommended for better mobile internet access.

8. Is it allowed to take photographs of people?

Always ask for permission before photographing individuals, especially in rural areas and markets.

9. What fitness level is required for sightseeing?

A moderate fitness level is recommended, especially for excursions to natural sites and islands.

10. What kind of shoes should I wear?

Comfortable walking shoes are recommended, especially for exploring cities and nature reserves.

11. How is the power supply in Senegal?

The electric outlets in Senegal are 220 volts, while U.S. appliances are 110 volts. This means you will not be able to use your U.S. small appliances and devices in Senegal. The exceptions are laptops, phone chargers and other such devices which are usually universal and should work in Senegal. You might need an adapter for these devices, however, as the outlets in Senegal are a different shape than those common in the U.S.

12. Can I drink alcohol in Senegal?

Yes, alcohol is available in hotels, restaurants, and bars, although Senegal is a predominantly Muslim country and alcohol may not be widely available in some areas.

13. Is smoking allowed in Senegal?

Smoking is allowed in outdoor areas but is restricted in enclosed public spaces.

14. What food options are available in Senegal?

In the hotels we have a full buffet breakfast each day. Senegalese cuisine includes dishes

like thieboudienne (fish and rice), yassa (marinated chicken or fish), and mafe (peanut stew). Vegetarian options are also available.

Money & Costs

15. What currency is used in Senegal?

The West African CFA Franc (XOF) is the official currency. Credit and debit cards are accepted in major hotels and restaurants, but cash is preferred in markets and rural areas.

16. How much does a meal cost in Senegal?

A meal at a mid-range restaurant costs about \$15-\$25, while street food or casual dining can be around \$5-\$10.

17. Can I use U.S. dollars in Senegal?

U.S. dollars are not widely accepted. It is best to exchange money at banks or Forex Bureaus.

Transportation & Getting Around

18. Do I need an international driver's license to rent a car?

Yes, an International Driving Permit (IDP) is required to rent a car. Traffic conditions can be hectic, so hiring a driver is recommended.

19. Is public transportation safe?

Public transportation, such as minibuses and shared taxis, can be crowded and confusing. Tourists are advised to use private taxis or ride-hailing services.

Health & Safety

20. Is tap water safe to drink?

We will supply you with bottled water each day. It is also available in your hotel rooms. Although the locals all drink tap water it is very heavily chlorinated and is fine for brushing teeth and bathing, but is not recommended for drinking. The hotels and the restaurants that we select for you, all use purified water to make their ice cubes. So you should feel free to add ice cubes to your drinks.

21. Do I need travel insurance?

Yes, travel insurance is highly recommended for medical emergencies, lost luggage, and trip cancellations.

However, our company offers optional travel insurance through Allianz Global, a leader in the travel insurance field. You can click the link below or visit our website, www.africanconnections-usa.com, to get a quote.

https://www.agentmaxonline.com/agentmaxweb/widgets/quotetool.html?widgetid=859099&ac_cam=F212819&code=ABIYU4TLWGBGTNHC6ZWLRSKAR65GB6C5JLBJOIXR7QY3M6I5HDDHZDIECAM4JHS6KBOBIU5FYWBJM3BAHKTFTOR572B73AM4ZH74ZMN XVK 3YLBWT3Z3F4X4R3Z53LEU4

22. Should I bring my own medicine?

Bring sufficient prescribed medication for your trip. Pharmacies are available, but specific medicines may not always be in stock.

Activities

23. Is there time for shopping?

Yes! Senegal is known for its vibrant markets, where you can buy traditional fabrics, masks, jewelry, and handcrafted souvenirs.

24. Can I make personal purchases?

Yes, budget around \$8-\$25 per day for personal expenses like snacks, drinks, and souvenirs. Larger purchases can be made with credit cards in major stores.

Prepare to be Amazed!

Beneath the lively rhythm of modern Senegal lies a country where ancient traditions, colonial heritage, and vibrant cultures meet the warmth of West Africa's Atlantic coast. From the historic streets of Gorée Island to the music-filled markets of Dakar, Senegal is soulful, colorful, and unforgettable. Have your cameras ready!

The African Connections Team is eagerly awaiting your arrival in Senegal and is ready to assist you as you prepare for your unforgettable African adventure!

